Axel Malmcrona

Curriculum Vitae as of October 2026

Department of Economics, University of Gothenburg
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Education

2022– PhD Candidate, University of Gothenburg
Dissertation supervisors: Johan Stennek and Andreas Dzemski
Expected graduation: June 2027

Feb–Mar 2026 Visiting Student, Central European University
Host: *Prof.* Andrea Weber

2016–2019 Master of Science in Economics and Social Sciences, Bocconi University
Thesis supervisor: *Prof.* T. Le Barbanchon

2011–2014 Bachelor of Science in Economics and Business, Lund University
Thesis supervisor: *Prof.* F. N. G. Andersson

Previous Positions

2020–2022 Research Assistant, Swedish Institute for Social Research, Stockholm University
2019–2020 Research Assistant, Swedish Fiscal Policy Council
Sep 2018–Feb 2019 Intern, Swedish Ministry of Finance
Nov 2017–Jan 2018 Intern, European Commission
2015–2016 Billing Administrator, Fujitsu

Research Interests

Primary Labor economics, Industrial organization
Secondary Policy evaluation

Work in Progress

Monopsony and Wage Inequality in Sweden: The Effect of Markdowns on Immigrant and Gender Wage Gaps (2026)
with Theodor Friederiszick and Nelson Sunuwar

How Do Firms Exercise Labor Market Power? Evidence from Swedish Pharmacies (2026)
with Theodor Friederiszick and Nelson Sunuwar

The Job Diversion Matrix: How Workers' Alternatives Determine the Harm from Layoffs and Mergers (2026)
with Theodor Friederiszick and Nelson Sunuwar

Negotiating Labor Market Power (-)
Data collection on individual union membership in Sweden is under way in collaboration with Produktivitetskommissionen, a joint initiative of Sweden's industrial unions.

Publications

Kan bättre hälsa minska brottslighet? (2022)
Randi Hjalmarsson, Matthew J. Lindquist, and Axel Malmcrona. *Ekonomisk Debatt*, 50(4), 30–43.

Seminars and Conferences

2026 EARIE Conference Presentation; PhD Research Seminar (Central European University); Seminar (Arena Idé); Applied Micro/Labor Seminar (University of Gothenburg)

2024 Applied Micro/Labor Seminar (University of Gothenburg)

2023 Applied Micro/Labor Seminar (University of Gothenburg)

Service and Community Engagement

2022– Volunteer Tutor, Stockholm Public Library, Högdalen
2021–2022 Exam Invigilator, Swedish Scholastic Aptitude Test, Stockholm
2023–2024 PhD Representative on the Department Board, Department of Economics, University of Gothenburg

Teaching Experience

Role	Course	Term(s)	Language
Lecturer	Applied Economics	Fall 2023–Spring 2027	Swedish
TA	Statistics 1B	Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2026	Swedish
TA	Statistics 1B	Fall 2024, Fall 2025	English
TA	Statistics: Basic Course 2	Fall 2025	Swedish
TA	Economics in Practice	Spring 2024, Spring 2025	Swedish
Marking exams	Labor Economics 2	2022 (Stockholm University)	Swedish

Grants

2026	Adlerbertska Stipendiestiftelsen	20 000 sek
2025	Hedeliusstipendium (Visiting CEU)	26 000 sek
2024	Adlerbertska Stipendiestiftelsen	20 000 sek
	Wilhelm och Martina Lundgrens Vetenskapsfond	75 000 sek
	Donationsnämndens stipendier	15 000 sek

Technical Skills

Data Analysis & Visualization: Stata, R, Python
Agentic AI: Claude, Codex, ChatGPT

Languages

Swedish: Native
English: Fluent
Italian: Basic

References

Name: *Professor* Johan Stennek
Email: johan.stennek@economics.gu.se
Phone: +46 70 512 14 01

Name: *Associate Professor* Andreas Dzemski
Email: andreas.dzemski@economics.gu.se
Phone: +46 31 786 65 12

Name: *Professor* Andrea Weber
Email: webera@ceu.edu

Research Description and Dissertation Summary

I am a labor economist who is interested in how employer market power affects worker wages. My empirical approach is to apply structural models from industrial organization to the labor market, using rich Swedish microdata on workers and firms. I document that different groups of workers are differently exposed to firm market power and are paid different fractions of their marginal productivity. This feature of the labor market partially explains the gender and immigrant-native wage gaps. I also study what features of the labor market give rise to monopsony power, allowing firms to pay workers less than their marginal productivity.

In my paper *Monopsony and Wage Inequality in Sweden: The Effect of Markdowns on Immigrant and Gender Wage Gaps* I identify firm market power by estimating production functions for almost 150,000 firms in 61 industries. The rich microdata allows me to account for firm-specific productivity and to differentiate market power by worker category. A key result is a counterfactual exercise which shows that

in 2023, the end of the sampling period, equal exposure to firm market power for immigrant and native workers would close the immigrant-native wage gap. The same exercise for men and women closes half of the gender wage gap.

In *The Job Diversion Matrix: How Workers' Alternatives Determine the Harm from Layoffs and Mergers*, my co-authors and I study how workers' alternative job opportunities shape their vulnerability to plant closures and mergers. We combine a discrete choice model with Swedish administrative data to estimate where workers would move if their current job disappeared. We show that, in the year after a plant closure, workers with few alternatives experience earnings losses roughly three times as large as those with many alternatives. We also find that earnings losses and increased unemployment following mergers are concentrated among mergers that bring close job alternatives under common ownership. Our approach identifies which employers compete for the same workers and provides a way to screen mergers for potential harm to workers before they take place.

In *How Do Firms Exercise Labor Market Power? Evidence from Swedish Pharmacies*, we study how much of their potential wage-setting power firms actually exercise. We combine a structural model of labor supply and demand with quasi-experimental variation from the breakup of the Swedish pharmacy monopoly to estimate how firms respond to increased competition. Detailed data on licensed pharmacists and pharmacy sales allow us to model both job choices of workers and wage-setting of firms. Our estimates imply that pharmacy chains exercise about a quarter of their potential labor market power. Counterfactual simulations show that the monopoly breakup raised wages at the average pre-reform pharmacy by 3.3%, compared with 11.4% under full exercise of that power.

In *Negotiating Labor Market Power*, I am collecting data on individual union membership in Sweden in collaboration with Produktivitetskommissionen, a joint initiative of Sweden's industrial unions. The project is at the data-collection stage and will examine how worker organization and collective bargaining interact with competition between employers to shape wages and bargaining power. I am particularly interested in whether unions counterbalance employers' wage-setting power, how this role depends on workers' alternative job opportunities, and how the gains from collective bargaining are distributed across workers. Linking union membership to administrative data on workers and firms will allow us to study these questions at both the individual and workplace levels.